David Almona

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytics professional with experience in statistical modeling, sports analytics, and program development. Focused on analyzing complex datasets, communicating insights to stakeholders, and building solutions that contribute to organizational impact.

EDUCATION

Centre College **2022 – May 2026**

Bachelor of Science in Economics (Major), Data Science (Minor) *Danville, KY*

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.61 | **Major GPA:** 3.67
- **Relevant Coursework:** Modern Calculus I, Applied Machine Learning, Statistical Modeling, Econometrics, Empirical Analysis, Data Visualization, Intro to Management, Programming and Problem Solving, Economics of College Sports, Managerial Finance.
- **Leadership & Activities:** Track and Field Student-Athlete | Resident Assistant | Co-President: Centre Brother-to-Brother Club.
- **Programming Languages & Tools:** R, Python, SQL, Stata, Tableau, Power BI, Git/GitHub, Jupyter Notebook, Microsoft Excel.

EXPERIENCE

Basketball Analytics Intern **Feb 2026 – Sep 2026**

Los Angeles Sparks *Remote*

- Build statistical player comparison frameworks that inform roster and game strategy decisions for the coaching and front office staff
- Maintain and expand internal analytics databases, improving data reliability for downstream decision making
- Deliver game-by-game, seasonal, and player evaluation reports that shaped how staff track performance trends league-wide

Business Program Development Fellow **Sep 2025 – Dec 2025**

Sustainable Business Network (SBN) of Massachusetts *Cambridge, MA*

- Built the Technical Assistance Pilot Program from scratch, creating SBN's first structured path connecting micro-entrepreneurs to affordable consulting
- Designed multi-step intake process including dual Google Forms (20+ questions each), interview framework, database management system, and memorandum of understanding template
- Matched businesses to consultants based on readiness and expertise alignment, expanding access to support for underrepresented business owners

Undergraduate Sports Analytics Research Fellow **Jun 2025 – Jul 2025**

Carnegie Mellon University - Statistics & Data Science | *Capstone Project* *Pittsburgh, PA*

- 1 of 16 students selected for a fully funded 8-week research program
- Trained and compared five models (including XGBoost) to predict forced turnovers within 5 seconds of a press, using 252,646 tracked pressing sequences from 502 MLS matches and 10Hz player tracking data from SkillCorner
- Oral presentation at the Carnegie Mellon Sports Analytics Conference 2025 & American Soccer Insights Summit 2026

Data Analyst: Qualitative & Quantitative Insights **Mar 2025 – Jun 2025**

Beats by Dr. Dre, via Extern | *Capstone Project*

Remote

- Conducted market research by analyzing 4,628 consumer survey responses and scraped product reviews using Python (Pandas, NumPy, TextBlob) to identify market opportunities and feature preferences for a wireless speaker product launch
- Delivered strategic assessment recommending $150-250 price point based on consumer insights, demographic segmentation, sentiment analysis, and competitive gap analysis

PROJECTS

2026 FIFA World Cup Prediction | Personal Project | *R & Python* **Jun 2026**

- Projected tournament outcomes using a Poisson regression model and Monte Carlo simulations
- Finished 4th of 47 entries in a public prediction contest on X (fka. Twitter), ranking 2nd by Brier score

Loan Default Prediction | Applied Machine Learning Course Project | *Python* **Mar 2026**

- Modeled loan default risk on 307K Home Credit applicants, comparing 6 ML algorithms with 5-fold cross-validation
- Tuned decision threshold via F2 score to prioritize recall, reducing costly false negatives for the lender

National Olympic Performance: Determinants of Medal Counts | Econometrics | *Stata* **Sep 2024 – Dec 2024**

- Analyzed how economic, demographic, and historical factors relate to national medal counts across multiple Summer Olympics
- Built and compared panel regression models with country fixed effects to address unobserved heterogeneity and model specification issues

MENTORSHIP

- Mentee, WeStutter@Work Mentorship Program
- Mentee, 2026 NFL Big Data Bowl Mentorship Program (selected from competitive applicant pool)
- Selected Participant, Philadelphia Eagles Virtual Development Series (Business Operations)